

The TOUGH Ones

Out of the 60 firms we talked to, more than 20 shared concrete plans for their growth. From those we identified the top 16 with unique and interesting strategies. Hope you will find some that can be applied at your end too

APW President System

We are introducing new products and innovations as part of our ongoing efforts to expand our offerings, identifying new customer requirements and increasing production and warehousing capacity to match these requirements. For example, previously we were supplying enclosures to our customers like IBM and TCS but now we are also providing a multilayer power solution. It includes data centre monitoring and planning. We have just completed the purchase of land very close to our existing manufacturing unit at Attibele (Bangalore) as part of our ongoing capex, plans and construction of the new plating facility and factory premises is expected to complete by August-September 2009.



Pramod Agase
COO

Neural Systems

The current situation is right to invest in manpower resources, add new verticals including R&D activity and re-plan the business for the next 5 to 10 years based on the type and scale of industry. It would be an idealistic situation for overlapping the first one or two years of your revised business plan (generally a moratorium period) with this period of slow economic situation. In a nutshell, it is an ideal situation to invest in long-term plans emphasising on R&D and IP with the right kind of talented manpower (right time to acquire talent in the market with optimised expenses on manpower).



B.M. Basavaraj
Chief Executive

A.V. Systems

Instead of too much cost-cutting, we are trying to expand our customer base to include new verticals. Due to the increase of terror attacks in the past few months, we are trying to provide a totally customised security solution for government sectors and PSUs. We believe in both inorganic and organic growth strategies. We have an immediate plan to launch a cost-effective security solution by using video management system and in the near future we will try to capture the security solution market of middle-east by acquiring a growing IT company of that region.



K. Tarun Singh
GM-Project

Persang Alloy

As the only Indian company exporting solder products, we are not compromising on quality by adopting any cost-cutting means. Our strategy is to increase sales revenue by expanding the line of products. We have already introduced some environment-friendly products like lead-free solders. We are building a new state-of-the-art manufacturing plant at Waghodia, 30 km from Vadodra. It will operate in a fully automatic mode and already equipped with the latest technology from Shenma Technology Inc., Taiwan. The plant will be nearly three times our existing capacity, i.e., around 3000 MT per annum. We are also planning to increase our workforce by 30-40 per cent by 2010. We may strengthen our business process by utilising an ERP solution.



Persang Bhai
Chairman

Circuit (Systems) India

When the market is unpredictable and the going gets tough, we invest and expand in keeping with our long-term focus. We also intend to enter into new technology fields catering to high-frequency products, ensuring that we move along with innovative technology/new materials including Teflon and as well as customer requirement. We are expanding in terms of augmenting our capacity. We are building a new factory at Gandhinagar, Gujarat-SEZ complex. This will be nearly two-and-a-half times our existing capacity and we intend to cater to both domestic and export markets.



C.S. Bhaskar
chief customer support-technical

Hita Technology

Our long-term contract basis business strategy is strong enough to tackle the global recession. We have a niche market mainly covering the big corporate houses in BFI and private banking sector. We are planning to increase our market share by catching new corporate houses both in domestic and international markets. Moreover, we are going to provide a better price for our customers by renegotiating with some vendors in Taiwan as their economy is in a disastrous condition. We are contributing to Indian growth by introducing a unique line of products in the area of renewable energy. Our new 'Home UPS' product range will have an in-built interface to make it compatible with solar panels.



Arun Ghosh
MD

Tomen Electronics India

Tomen's confidence in Indian economic growth is still very strong. As a Japanese company we are not facing any problem in capital investment, and are expecting 30 per cent year-to-year growth in sales revenue in 2009. Yes, Q4 2008 has been slow, but we are utilising this temporary slowdown phase for brand building and customer relationship development.

In 2009, Tomen will start local warehousing and billing in INR to better support our large customers. We are also planning to add about 10 per cent staff, mainly field application engineers, to further strengthen our technical support to customers.



Sunny Malhotra
President

Navion

The effect of this economic crisis is very low on our revenue as we have a long-term strategy and a clear plan to execute it. It is what we have been focused on for the last couple of years and we will continue to drive it forward. We are going to introduce new lines of product in passive components. We are following niche marketing policy for the sectors like consumer electronics and industrial electronics. We are also trying to enhance the productivity of our sales force by using some sales automation tools.



Nikesh Sanghvi
MD